

Customer Data Privacy and Retention Policy

Northwind KnowledgeOps Group

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Sample scenario: This document is suited for questions about retention periods, privacy requests, data minimization, legal holds, and restricted data.

Document Purpose	This sample policy is designed for AI document ingestion, semantic retrieval, and grounded response testing in a business portal.
Review Cycle	Reviewed annually or when operating conditions, regulations, or internal controls materially change.

Quick Reference

Primary Audience	Product teams, support teams, data analysts, engineering, customer success.
Default Retention	Customer support case data is retained for three years unless a contract requires a different period.
Deletion Request SLA	Validated deletion requests must be completed within thirty calendar days unless a legal hold applies.
Restricted Data	Payment card data, government identifiers, and health data require explicit Data Governance approval.

1. Purpose

This policy defines how customer data must be collected, used, retained, deleted, and protected across company systems.

The company collects only the customer data needed to provide services, support customers, operate products, meet contractual obligations, and satisfy legal requirements.

2. Data Minimization

Teams must collect the minimum customer data needed for the approved business purpose. Optional fields must be clearly marked and must not be required unless approved by Data Governance.

Customer data collected for one purpose must not be reused for unrelated analytics, marketing, or product experiments without documented approval.

3. Retention Periods

Customer support case data is retained for three years from case closure unless a contract, regulatory rule, or legal hold requires a different period.

Product telemetry that is not linked to an identifiable customer account is retained for eighteen months. Identifiable telemetry requires a documented business purpose and owner approval.

Inactive customer account records are reviewed after twenty-four months of inactivity and deleted or anonymized unless retention is required for billing, security, legal, or contractual reasons.

4. Privacy Requests

Validated customer deletion, correction, and access requests must be completed within thirty calendar days unless a legal hold, active dispute, or statutory exception applies.

Support teams must route privacy requests to Data Governance and may not promise deletion or disclosure timelines outside the approved process.

5. Restricted Data

Payment card data, government identifiers, health data, biometric data, and children-related data are restricted data types and require explicit Data Governance approval before collection or processing.

Restricted data must not be stored in logs, free-text support notes, analytics dashboards, or shared spreadsheets.

6. Legal Holds and Exceptions

A legal hold suspends normal deletion and anonymization activities for the affected data set until Legal releases the hold in writing.

Exceptions to this policy must identify the data involved, business justification, risk controls, approver, and expiration date.

Document Control: This document is a fictional sample for training, demonstration, and AI testing. It is not legal, HR, accounting, or compliance advice.